



OTAVALENS

TRADITIONAL TRADERS

TUCKED HIGH IN THE ECUADORIAN ANDES, the valley town

of Otavalo has been attracting visitors to its market for hundreds of years. The local people, known as Otavalens, speak Quichua, one of the languages of the old

A lasting culture

The Otavalens have prospered through their dealings with both the *Mestizo* population (*Mestizos* are of mixed Spanish/Amerindian origin) and the wider commercial world, yet they have kept a powerful sense of their own identity. Not only their language, but also their houses, their clothing, their crafts, and their basic culture are rooted in native tradition.

TEAM SPIRIT

Working outdoors on a simple elevated frame, these country laborers are using a two-man handsaw to turn huge eucalyptus logs into long, straight planks. The lumber they are producing is intended for the roofs of village houses in the Otavalo valley.

Otavalan men dress their hair in a long braid or shimba that hangs down almost to their waist.



HOME COOKING

Ecuador is a fertile land whose rich soil nourishes a plentiful supply of fruit and vegetables. This girl prepares *calabash*, a long gourd grown there for thousands of years. Inedible when fully grown, the young gourd can be cooked and eaten in a wide variety of ways.

PANPIPES

Popular throughout the Andes, native panpipes are made from reeds of different lengths tied together with plant fiber. This Otavalan man is playing a relatively small set, but some larger versions have as many as 30 pipes.

